AA-D-170A
February 20, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. AA-D-170
November 24, 1958

# FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

## DESK, FLAT TOP

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a corrosion-resisting steel, nurse's desk of the single pedestal type.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| PPP-B-585 | - | Boxes, Wood, Wirebound. |
| PPP-B-601 | - | Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood. |
| PPP-B-621 | - | Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner. |
| PPP-B-636 | - | Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard. |
| PPP-B-1055 | - | Barrier Material, Waterproofed Flexible. |

Federal Standards:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Fed. Std. No. 66 | - | Steel, Chemical Composition and Hardenability. |
| Fed. Std. No. 123 | - | Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies). |
| Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151 | - | Metals, Test Methods. |

FSC 6530

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Goverment activites may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer. DPSC Drawing 1097, from which the herein referenced Figure 1 was reduced, is available upon request to the contracting officer).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. Unless otherwise specified before production is commenced, a sample of the desk on contract and each component part thereof shall be made ready for the contracting officer or his authorized representative to examine and test to determine compliance with this specification (see 6.2). Approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the contractor of responsibility from compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification.

3.2 Material. Material shall be as specified herein. When matetial for any particular component is not definitely specified, it shall be of the highest quality used for the purpose in commercial practice suitable in every respect for the purpose intended. Where material sizes and thicknesses are given herein, they shall be the minimum nominal sizes or thicknesses. Commercial tolerances on these sizes and thicknesses are permissible.

3.2.1 Sheet and strip. Sheet and strip shall be corrosion-resisting steel, conforming to AISI 302 or 304 of Fed. Std. No. 66.

3.2.2 Bars and rod. Bars and rod shall be class AISI 302 or 304 corrosion-resisting steel as specified in Fed. Std. No. 66.



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3.2.3 Tubing. Tubing shall be seamless or continuously welded corrosion-resisting steel, and shall conform to the requirements of AISI 302 or 304 as specified in Fed. Std. No. 66.

3.2.4 Handles. Drawer pull handles shall be of brass, bronze, steel, corrosion-resisting steel, or anodized aluminum. Where brass, bronze, or steel handles are furnished, they shall be plated with chromium over nickel.

3.2.5 Welding rod. Welding rod shall be of a suitable grade of corrosion-resisting steel, similar in composition to the material welded.

3.2.6 Hardware. Fasteners and the drawer lock shall be class AISI 302, 304 or 416 corrosion-resisting steel, chrome plated carbon steel or brass.

3.3 Construction. Desk shall be of the single pedestal type. The pedestal shall be located at the right end of the desk, and shall be fitted with three drawers. The desk shall have six tubular legs, each fitted with a rubber crutch-type tip. The legs and pedestal shall be joined and braced with both tubular and flat bar braces and welded into a rigid unit. The desk shall rest evenly with all six leg crutch tips contacting a flat surface and shall not shake nor wobble when tested as specified in 4.4.2. Dimensions and construction shall be in accordance with figure 1 and this specification. All dimensions shall be in inches and where dimensional tolerances are not indicated, the following shall apply:

| | |
|---|---|
| Under 2 inches | ± 1/32 |
| 2 inches or more but less than 6 inches | ± 1/16 |
| 6 inches or more but less than 12 inches | ± 1/8 |
| 12 inches or more but less than 24 inches | ± 1/4 |
| 24 inches or more | ± 1/2 |

Tolerances shall not be cumulative. Material sizes and thicknesses shall be as follows:

| | |
|---|---|
| Legs | 1 inch outside diameter, 0.065 inch wall (No. 16, Birmingham Wire gage). |
| Braces | 3/4 inch outside diameter, 0.065 inch wall (No. 16, Birmingham Wire gage). |
| Frames and brace lug | 1 inch by 1/4 inch. |
| Top | 0.0598 inch (No. 16, U.S. Standard gage). |
| Pedestal housing, bottom, top rail, and drawer-dividing fascia strips | 0.0359 inch (No. 20, U.S. Standard gage). |
| Drawer bodies | 0.0359 inch (No. 20, U.S. Standard gage). |



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| | |
|---|---|
| Drawer fronts and box filler | 0.0299 inch (No. 22 U.S. Standard gage). |
| Drawer slides | 0.0598 inch (No. 16, U.S. Standard gage). |
| Guardrails | 3/8 inch minimum diameter rod. |

3.3.1 Frame. Frame shall consist of six tubular legs braced with smaller tubular members at the left side between the front and rear legs, at the back between the left rear and center rear legs, and between the brace on the left side and the lug welded to the lower frame inside the pedestal. There shall be two frames of flat bar stock inside the pedestal top and underneath the pedestal bottom, and a "U" shaped frame of flat bar stock around the entire top excluding the pedestal.

3.3.2 Pedestal. The pedestal which forms a housing for the drawers shall be located on the right side of the desk. The back, sides, and front corner panels shall be of one continuous sheet encircling the legs and bar frames. The bottom shall be one piece, with all edges turned down, with front edge forming the lower front horizontal rail of the drawer opening. There shall be, in addition, a top rail and two intermediate drawer-dividing rails located and joined as shown on figure 1.

3.3.3 Drawers. All drawers shall have box type double wall fronts with sound insulation. Drawer sides and bottoms shall be of one continuous sheet. Top edges of drawer sides shall be flanged or hemmed, depending on the style and location of drawer slides. Drawer back shall be either pan shaped with all flanges extending back, or shall have side and bottom edges flanged in and top edge flanged back. As an alternate, drawer sides, bottoms, and backs shall be of one continuous sheet. Drawer components shall be welded together to form a rigid assembly. Drawers shall close silently against suitable rubber bumpers which shall be securely attached in a suitable location. The drawer pull handle shall be secured by screws. Handles shall be of cast or double-shell construction, and shall be shaped for convenient and comfortable handling. Inside dimensions of drawers shall be not less than 20-1/2 inches by 11-3/8 inches. The two top drawers shall have an inside depth of not less than 3-1/2 inches, and the bottom drawer shall have an inside depth of not less than 7 inches.

3.3.3.1 Drawer slides. Drawers shall operate on "L" shaped or channel-shaped slides welded to the drawer sides, riding in channel shaped mating members welded to the rear and front legs inside the pedestal. Each half of each pair of slides shall be fitted with a rubber or nylon tired ball-bearing roller, making a total of four rollers for each drawer. Drawers shall operate smoothly with a minimum of sidesway. Slides shall have stops to prevent inadvertent removal of the drawer. Stops shall not preclude removal of the drawer for cleaning purposes, when desired. Slides shall have detents or shall be pitched at a slight angle towards the rear to prevent drawers from rolling open, if the desk is placed on a floor slightly out of level. Drawer slides and stops shall function as specified above when tested in accordance with 4.4.4.



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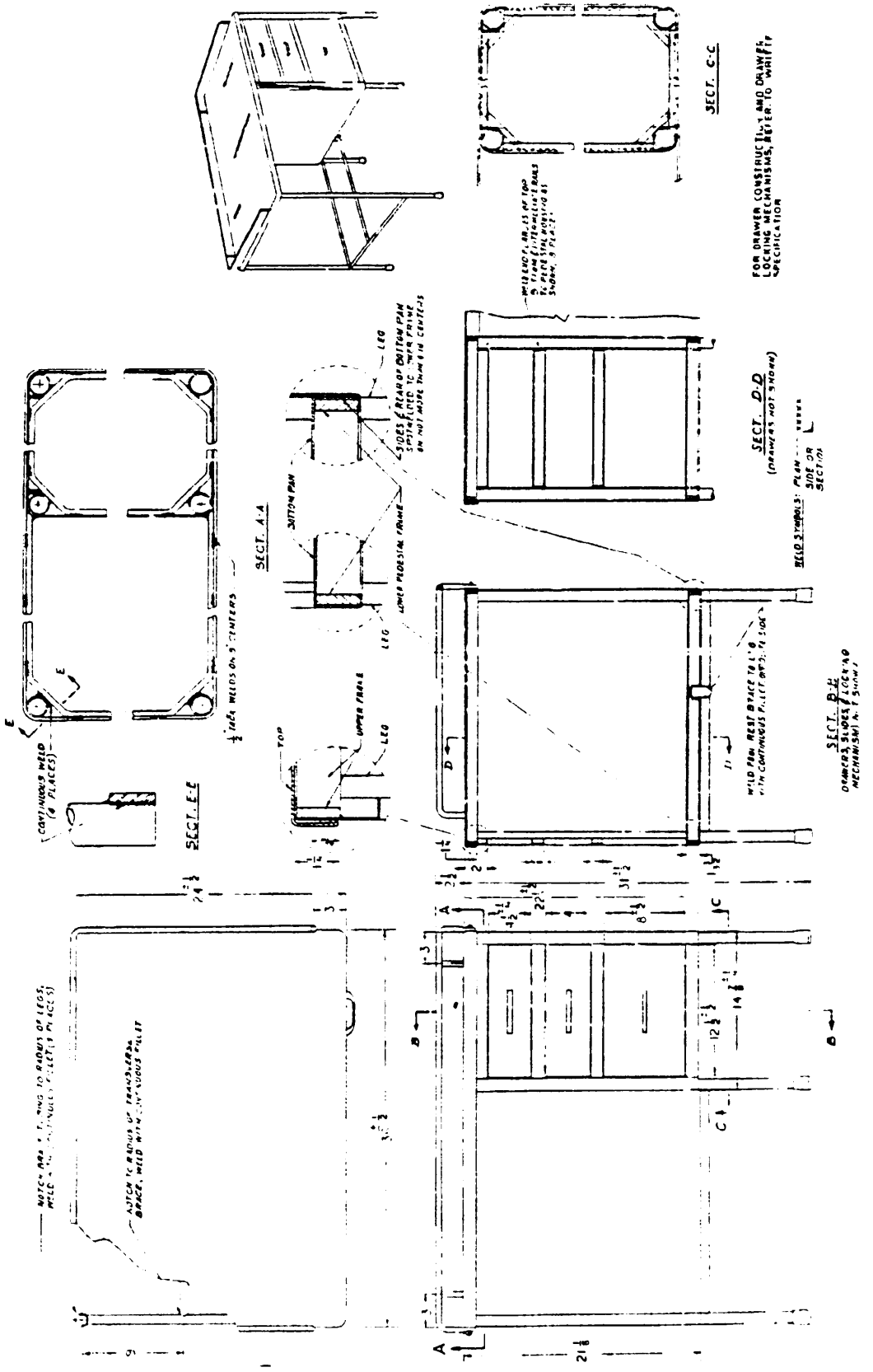



Figure 1. Desk, flat top.

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3.3.3.2 Drawer-locking mechanism. Top drawer shall be fitted with a lock and supplied with two keys. Each desk shall be keyed individually. The locking mechanism shall be of such design that with the top drawer closed, the lower drawers shall lock automatically when closed (see 4.4.3). The locking member attached to the two lower drawers shall be affixed to the backs of the drawers in such a manner or in such a position as to preclude buckling of the drawer back by pulling on these drawers when they are locked. The locking mechanism shall be ruggedly constructed and securely welded to the back of the pedestal, and shall lock positively to the extent that the locked drawers shall not be capable of being opened, except by means of a key, without seriously damaging the desk.

3.3.4 Top. Top shall be of one continuous sheet with all edges turned down and hemmed. Corners of the top shall be rounded to conform to the contour of the legs, and shall be fully welded, ground, and polished to eliminate all traces of the seams. A longitudinal hat-shaped channel (not shown in figure 1) shall be spot welded to and extend the full underside length of the top. The channel shall be located midway between the front and back of the top and shall be a 3 by 1 inch channel of AISI 302 or 304 corrosion-resisting steel, 0.063 inch thick (No. 16 USS gage). The channel shall be made in two pieces to provide clearance in the area of the intersecting pedestal face and flat bar brace.

3.3.5 Guardrail. Guardrail shall be continuous around the back and ends of the desk. Rail shall be bent at each end to form uprights, and shall have two additional uprights of similar material continuously welded to the rail in the position shown on figure 1. All uprights shall be properly flattened at their lower ends, drilled, and secured to the desk through the frame with roundhead machine screws, nuts, and lockwashers.

3.4 Welding. Welds shall be durable and sound in every detail. Spotwelding shall be accomplished in such manner as to assure thorough well-fused welds of maximum strength. Prior to welding, all components shall be properly aligned and secured in their proper positions to assure a straight, rigid, and level assembly. All welds shall be cleaned in accordance with the best commercial practice. All normally visible welds, including welds visible when the drawers are open, shall be ground smooth and polished so as to blend in with the adjacent surfaces. Spot welds that weld drawer sides to the drawer body do not require grinding and polishing but shall be cleaned as described above. All indentations, extrusions, and discolorations due to spotwelding that are normally visible, including those visible with drawers open, shall be filled, ground and polished smooth.



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3.5 Finish. All normally visible surfaces of the desk, including all surfaces of drawers visible when open, shall have a No. 4 commercial grind polish. All other surfaces shall have a No. 2B mill finish, or better. The finish of the handles shall match that of the desk. Finished unit shall be cleaned of all foreign matter including but not limited to dirt, grease, oil and metal chips.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Desks shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability. All burrs shall be removed and all sharp edges broken to eliminate completely any possibility of injury and the catching or tearing of clothing of personnel working at or about the desks.

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the components or materials may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.



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4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table I.

TABLE I.

| | Inspection level | AQL (percent defective) |
|---|---|---|
| For visual examination<br>Major defects | S-2 | 2.5 |
| Minor defects | S-2 | 6.5 |
| For dimensional examination | S-2 | 2.5 |

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as shown in table II. Acceptance number shall be zero, and not less than three samples shall be taken regardless of lot size.

TABLE II.

| Characteristic | Requirement | Test Procedure | Inspection level |
|---|---|---|---|
| Material | 3.2 | 4.4.1 | S-1 |
| Stability | 3.3 | 4.4.2 | S-1 |
| Drawer locking mechanism | 3.3.3.2 | 4.4.3 | S-1 |
| Drawer slides | 3.3.3.1 | 4.4.4 | S-1 |

4.3 Examination. The desks shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the classification of defects shown in table III. Examination shall not be restricted to the classified possible defects listed below.



level. Drawer slides and stops shall remain in place above when tested

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TABLE III.

| Categories | Defects |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 101 | Desk assembly not complete with specified components. |
| 102 | Desk not rigidly and squarely assembled. |
| 103 | Desk legs fail to bear uniformly on a flat level surface. |
| 104 | Edges and corners not free of burrs and sharp edges. |
| 105 | Drawers fail to operate smoothly, and do not close flush with face of pedestal. |
| 106 | Component parts and/or surfaces buckled or otherwise not free of deformed areas. |
| 107 | Visible internal and external welds do not blend with adjacent surfaces. |
| Minor | |
| 201 | Dimensions not as specified. |
| 202 | Keys for top drawer lock missing. |
| 203 | Finish not as specified; not free of excessive surface scratches, foreign matter, metal chips, oil or grease. |

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. Desks shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerance specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted, as necessary to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Chemical composition. Tests for chemical analysis shall be conducted in accordance with method 111.2 or 112.2 of Federal Test Method Standard No. 151.

4.4.2 Stability. Desks shall be tested for shake or wobble, by shaking by hand, while the desk is resting on a flat surface.

4.4.3 Drawer locking mechanism. With the top drawer closed and locked, the ability of the locking mechanism to automatically lock the lower drawers closed shall be tested.

4.4.4 Drawer slide and stops. Each drawer shall be tested for smooth, sway-free operation and ability of the slide stops to prevent inadvertent removal of the drawer. A five pound weight shall be in each drawer during the testing.



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4.5 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit preparation. Guardrails shall be removed from the desk top. Screws shall be packaged in a cloth bag and secured in a drawer. Drawers shall be adequately secured to prevent accidental opening. Exterior finished surfaces shall be protected by wrapping with kraft paper or by a kraft-paper shroud, and by cushioning at points of contact of interior braces or interior faces of container with corrugated fiberboard, or other suitable materials. Work shall be accomplished in such a manner as to insure against marring, scratching, or damage to the unit.

5.1.2 Level C. Desks shall be prepared for shipment in accordance with the contractors commercial practice which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the item for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Each desk shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 3 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601 overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2 or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V13c. The top, ends and sides of the wood boxes shall be lined with a waterproof barrier material conforming to PPP-B-1055, class L-2. Waterproof barrier material shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed as specified in PPP-B-636. Closure and strapping of the exterior container, shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Each desk shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 3 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic, variety DW, grade 500. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.



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5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking for shipment shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities.

5.3.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Item is intended for use in nurse's stations in hospitals.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c. When specific test facilities are required (see 4.1).
d. When preproduction sample is not required (see 3.1); all Department of Defense (DOD) activities (see 6.3).

6.3 First Article instructions for DOD activities. The Armed Services Procurement Regulations (ASPR) Section No. 1, Part No. 9 and Section VII relate to First Article approval. The paragraphs within this specification shall be deleted by DOD activities and the requirements of the ASPR included in the contract or purchase order.

6.4 This specification covers the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

| National Stock No. | Item Identification |
|---|---|
| 6530-00-705-4975 | DESK, FLAT TOP, Nurse's, Single Pedestal, Corrosion-Resisting Metal |

6.5 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet requirements.



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Preparing activity:

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

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NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

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B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

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